Mining

The economy in Western Australia relies heavily on mining. Mining is the removal of resources from the ground.

Resources are useful substances that humans dig up out of the ground. Resources can be classified as:

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An example of a resource is coal.

Coal is formed from _____that grew many years ago. They died and fell into s_____, where they were covered by s_____. High _____, _____ and a lack of _____ changed and c_____ the dead plants to give coal.

Coal is a useful resource as it can be burned to get energy.

Steps in Mining Resources

Mining is the removal of the resource from the ground and occurs in a couple of steps.

Exploration. This is where geologists look for areas that might have the resources they are after. It is the search for rocks containing the minerals.

1.

Method	Example of survey method
Aerial	
On-site methods	
Satellite	Satellite images produce.

2. **Mining**. This is the actual removal of the resources form the ground and uses many different methods such as open cut mining and dredging.

3. **Enrichment**. The c_____ the resource, increasing how much is in a particular v_____ of the mineral material.

4. **Extraction**. Chemical process to remove the wanted _____ from the ore. So for example aluminium is extracted from the ore Bauxite. This often happens at major industrial sites.